

JBL unveils iPhone 5 docks

JBL unveiled two new speaker systems that allow docking facilities for the iPhone 5's new smaller Lightning connector



New Rocksmith Pack available

Ubisoft has announced a new alternative rock songs pack for the critically acclaimed 'Rocksmith', available on Xbox Live and Playstation Network

Bazaar

ASUS GTX 660Ti DirectCU II TOP

A complete value for money card and a gamer's delight



Features	70
Performance.....	75
Build Quality	75
Value for money.....	75

Specifications

GPU Core clock: 1058 MHz;
GPU Boost clock: 1137 MHz; **CUDA cores:** 1344;
Memory: 2048MB; **Memory bus width:** 192-bit; **Display ports:** 2xDVI, 1xHDMI, 1xDisplayPort; **Accessories:** 1 x DVI to D-Sub adaptor, 1 x Power cable

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ASUS DirectCU II TOP edition cards are renowned for their top notch build quality and this GTX 660Ti card is no different. Its design though, is a bit different with the Direct CU II cooling unit and the fan section on top of it, extending beyond the PCB of the card by close to 40 mm. Heat-pipes protrude out from the top and the bottom of the heat sink. On the whole, it's an excellently constructed card. There are two DVI ports along with a single HDMI and DisplayPort respectively.

The GTX 660Ti is based on the GK104 GPU, the shaders are limited to 1344 and the memory bus-width has been reduced from 256-bit (which is seen on the GTX 670 and GTX 680) to 192-bit. Being a TOP edition card, this is factory

overclocked to 1058 MHz which is quite a jump from the stock 915 MHz clock speed.

Performance-wise it excels in all the benchmarks giving scores that are comparable to a stock GTX 670 card or a stock HD 7970. It is certainly better than HD 7950 according to our benchmarks. Even with the ASUS GTX. As compared to other GTX 660Ti cards, it performed at par with the ZOTAC GTX 660Ti AMP Edition card and was faster than Galaxy GTX 660 Ti GC 2GB card.

At ₹20,000 the ASUS GTX 660Ti DC2T offers great value for money when compared to the more expensive ZOTAC GTX 660Ti AMP edition which sells for around ₹24,000. Definitely worth considering.

Nimish Sawant



Price
₹20,000

ASUS F2A55-M

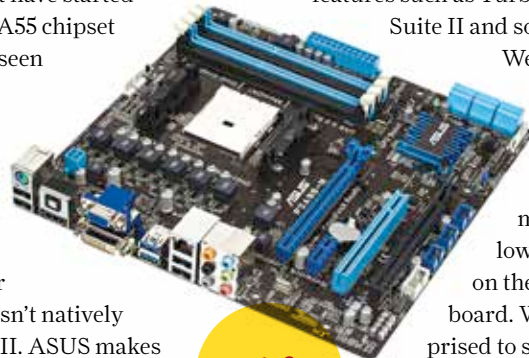
A decent board for your next HTPC, but price is a dampener

Supporting the AMD A55 chipset, this ASUS F2A55-M board comes with the FM2 socket which is meant for the latest Trinity series of APUs that have started coming in the market. The A55 chipset is the same one which was seen with the last generation of Llano APUs, but the socket is different with Trinity APUs. The A55 has certain limitations as compared to the higher end chipsets such as A75 or A85X. The A55 chipset doesn't natively support USB 3.0 or SATA III. ASUS makes use of the ASMedia controller for the USB 3.0 ports. Absence of SATA III will hit SATA III SSD performance and there is no third party SATA III controller on this board.

The board is well laid out, but we would have liked to have a heatsink atop the VRM module. It

comes with an on-board GPU boost which helps in overclocking the onboard GPU clock.

Finally, the board comes with proprietary ASUS features such as TurboV, EZStart, Fan Xpert, AI Suite II and so on.

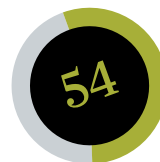


Price
₹5,950

We put in an AMD A10-5800K APU in this board along with 2x4GB of Kingston HyperX RAM at 1333MHz. The benchmark scores were slightly lower than what we had seen on the Gigabyte F2A85X-UP4 board. We were pleasantly surprised to see the APU overclocking to 4.2 GHz giving around 18 per cent boost in the CineBench R11.5 readings.

This is a very decent board for the feature-set provided, but we feel the price is high. At around ₹4,000 this is a good buy.

Nimish Sawant



Features	45
Overclocking.....	75
Build Quality	45
Value for money.....	50

Specifications

Chipset: AMD A55; **Socket:** FM2; **DIMMs:** 4; **SATA 2 ports:** 6; **PCIe x16 slots:** 2; **Display Ports:** 1xHDMI, 1xDVI, 1xD-Sub; **Form Factor:** Micro ATX; **USB 3.0 ports:** 2

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